

# BMAD Track Selection — Team Decision Guide

## THE THREE TRACKS

| Track       | Best For                            | Documents Produced                     | Workflow                  |
|-------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Quick Flow  | Small, clear-scope changes          | Tech-spec only                         | bmad-quick-dev (unified)  |
| BMad Method | Products, platforms, new features   | PRD + Architecture + UX                | Full 4-phase              |
| Enterprise  | Compliance, multi-tenant, regulated | PRD + Architecture + Security + DevOps | Full 4-phase + extensions |

## THE 5-QUESTION DECISION TEST

Ask in order. Stop at the first **Yes**.

| # | Question                                                                                    | If Yes →                              |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1 | Can the goal <b>NOT</b> be stated in one contradiction-free sentence?                       | Full Method                           |
| 2 | Does solving it require choosing between <b>architectural alternatives</b> ?                | Full Method                           |
| 3 | Does the change span <b>more than one service/module</b> ?                                  | Full Method                           |
| 4 | Does the team need a <b>written decision record</b> (compliance, onboarding, stakeholders)? | Full Method                           |
| 5 | Is this the team's <b>first 3–5 BMAD runs</b> ?                                             | Full Method (build calibration first) |

If all five answers are **No** → Quick-Dev . | Pick Enterprise over BMad Method if the change touches regulated data, multi-tenant boundaries, or requires formal security/DevOps sign-off.

Quick-Dev is not about "small" — it's about "fully understood." If the intent can be compressed into one sharp, unambiguous goal, Quick-Dev is safe. If not, no amount of automation will save you from unclear thinking.

## EXAMPLES

- ✓

Good fits for Quick-Dev
- ✗

NOT Quick-Dev (even if they seem small)

- 22/04/2026, 20:00
- BMAD Track Selection — Team Decision Guide
- Fix: login allows empty passwords — auth/validator.ts returns true on null
  - Add: created\_at column to orders table with default now( )
  - Refactor: convert UserService from callbacks to async/await
  - Patch: CVE in dependency — bump version, adjust one call site
  - UI: change primary button color and hover state

- "Add an API endpoint for X" — if it needs new auth, rate limiting, or schema change
  - "Fix the checkout bug" — if root cause is unknown
  - "Make login faster" — vague goal, not compressed intent
  - "Add SSO" — touches auth, config, user model, UI, session management
  - "Migrate from Redis to Memcached" — cross-cutting, needs architecture decision

THE ESCAPE HATCH

If you start Quick-Dev and the spec phase reveals cross-module impact, architectural alternatives, or unclear scope — STOP. Abort Quick-Dev. Route to PM agent for a PRD. Sunk-cost continuation is the #1 Quick-Dev failure mode.

RISK SUMMARY

| Mistake                                 | Cost                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Quick-Dev on unclear scope              | Model fills gaps with confident-wrong output → rework |
| Quick-Dev on cross-system work          | Integration bugs missed until QA or prod              |
| Full Method on a typo fix               | Wasted planning overhead, slower timeline             |
| Skipping Enterprise on regulated work   | Compliance gap, audit findings                        |
| Skipping Quick-Dev's spec approval step | Autonomous run has no frozen boundary → drift         |

"If you can write the goal in one sentence and it touches one module — Quick-Dev. Otherwise — Full Method. When the spec phase says otherwise, believe the spec phase."